NITI Aayog SDG India Index: Compendium of State Policy Innovations

Official Policy Reference Document - Volume I: Cross-Sectoral Analysis

DOCUMENT OVERVIEW & PURPOSE:

This compendium compiles empirical policy interventions across Indian States and Union Territories
for Sustainable Development Goals 3 (Health), 4 (Education), and 13 (Climate Action).
Published in collaboration with NITI Aayog SDG Monitoring Cell and Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MoSPI).

METHODOLOGY FOR PROGRESS BENCHMARKING:

States are classified into four progress categories based on index score (0-100):

1. Achiever (Score = 100): Full realization of 2030 Agenda targets.
2. Front Runner (Score 65-99): Exemplary performance; models for interstate peer learning.
3. Performer (Score 50-64): Steady upward trajectory requiring targeted programmatic acceleration.
4. Aspirant (Score 0-49): High-risk priority zones requiring urgent central assistance and emergency fiscal transfers.

LONGITUDINAL FINDINGS (2018-2023):

Nationally, the SDG composite score improved from 57 in 2018 to 66 in 2020-21 and 71 in 2023-24.
SDG 3 witnessed the fastest convergence among southern states (Kerala: 82, Tamil Nadu: 76).
SDG 4 showed substantial improvements in girls' gross enrolment, though digital infrastructure remains polarized.
SDG 13 remains the most volatile goal due to extreme weather disruptions and varying state renewable adoption speeds.

SDG 3 Health: State Comparative Insights & Interventions

Case Studies on Maternal Health, Universal Immunization & Out-of-Pocket Expense Reduction

HEALTHCARE FINANCING & PRIMARY CARE UPGRADES:

Empirical evidence confirms that state healthcare expenditure exceeding 2.5% of Gross State Domestic Product (GSDP) is the primary determinant of achieving Front Runner status in SDG 3.

KEY SUCCESS METRICS BY STATE:

- Kerala: High nurse-to-patient ratio (1:3 in ICUs) and institutionalized panchayat-level healthcare monitoring.
- Tamil Nadu: Decentralized medicine supply chain managed by TNMSC ensures zero stockouts of 312 essential drugs.
- Maharashtra: Integrated health grievance redressal portal and public-private dialysis partnerships in tier-2 cities.
- Andhra Pradesh: Dr. YSR Aarogyasri cashless health insurance scheme covers over 1,400 medical procedures.

PRIORITY CHALLENGES IN ASPIRANT STATES:

- Bihar, Uttar Pradesh, and Madhya Pradesh account for 48% of unmet emergency obstetric care needs.
- Primary Health Centre doctor absenteeism in remote rural tribal belts exceeds 28% without biometric incentives.
- Policy Mandate: Establish district-level medical colleges under the Centrally Sponsored Scheme to train and retain local doctors.

SDG 4 Education: Foundational Learning & Dropout Mitigation

Analysis of Retention Rates, Vocational Training & Digital Equity in Schools

EDUCATION REFORM UNDER NEP 2020:

The transition from 10+2 to 5+3+3+4 pedagogical structure emphasizes foundational cognitive development.

State education budgets must allocate minimum 20% to early childhood education and basic school infrastructure.

INTERSTATE TRANSFERABLE PRACTICES:

- Himachal Pradesh: Strong community-school synergy through active School Management Committees (SMCs).
- Delhi: Mentor teacher program paired experienced educators with struggling novice instructors.
- Karnataka: Edutech integration for remote high schools with recorded master-teacher lectures and bilingual subtitles.
- Tamil Nadu: Illam Thedi Kalvi (Education at Doorstep) volunteer tutoring recovered post-pandemic learning losses for 3.3 million stu

BOTTLENECK IDENTIFICATION:

- Secondary school dropout rates among marginalized communities remain concentrated at Grade 9 transition.
- Recommended intervention: Conditional cash transfer schemes linked to 80% school attendance for adolescent girls.
- Science laboratory equipment deficit identified in 34% of government secondary schools in northeastern hill states.

SDG 13 Climate Action: Renewable Transition & Disaster Mitigation

State Climate Action Plans (SAPCC), Rooftop Solar Integration & Forest Conservation

CLIMATE RESILIENCE STRATEGIES FOR SUB-NATIONAL GOVERNMENTS:

India's Nationally Determined Contributions (NDCs) commit to 50% non-fossil electric power capacity by 2030.
Sub-national implementation requires robust State Clean Energy Transition roadmaps.

EMPIRICAL STATE HIGHLIGHTS:

- Gujarat & Rajasthan: Combined installed solar and wind capacity surpasses 45 GW; grid stabilization through green corridors.
- Sikkim & Uttarakhand: Mountain ecology conservation policies; strict ban on riverbed chemical runoff.
- Kerala: First solar-powered international airport (Cochin) and decentralized micro-hydro projects in Western Ghats.
- Odisha: Comprehensive multi-hazard disaster warning system integrated with automated sirens in 122 coastal locations.

ACTIONABLE POLICY RECOMMENDATIONS FOR DEFICIT STATES:

1. Implement strict Renewable Purchase Obligations (RPO) on state power distribution companies (DISCOMs).
2. Establish dedicated State Disaster Mitigation Funds (SDMF) ringfenced for flood drainage and drought resilience.
3. Enforce urban heat island mitigation guidelines requiring cool roofs and 20% tree canopy in metropolitan planning.